

Table of Contents

DECLARATION.....	VII
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT	VIII
PHD COURSEWORK CERTIFICATE.....	IX
PRE-SUBMISSION SEMINAR CERTIFICATE	X
CERTIFICATE OF PLAGIARISM TEST.....	XI
SUPERVISOR CERTIFICATE.....	XII
LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS	XIII
LIST OF CASES	XX
LIST OF STATUTES.....	XXI
ABSTRACT OF THE THESIS	XXIII
STATEMENT OF PROBLEM.....	XXVII
RESEARCH OBJECTIVES	XXVIII
LITERATURE REVIEW	XXIX
<i>Books.....</i>	<i>xxix</i>
<i>Reports</i>	<i>xxxiv</i>
<i>Research Papers and Articles</i>	<i>xxxviii</i>
RESEARCH GAP	XLIII
RESEARCH QUESTIONS.....	XLV
HYPOTHESES.....	XLV
RESEARCH METHODOLOGY	XLVI
SCOPE AND LIMITATIONS.....	XLVII
THESIS OUTLINE	XLVIII
KEY FINDINGS OF THE STUDY	LIII
TESTING THE HYPOTHESIS	LIX
SUGGESTIONS & RECOMMENDATIONS.....	LXIII
CHAPTER 1	1
INTRODUCTION	1
1.1 STATEMENT OF PROBLEM	5
1.2 RESEARCH OBJECTIVES.....	6
1.3 LITERATURE REVIEW.....	7

1.3.1 Books.....	7
1.3.2 Reports	12
1.3.3 Research Papers and Articles.....	16
1.4 RESEARCH GAP	21
1.5 RESEARCH QUESTIONS.....	23
1.6 HYPOTHESES	23
1.7 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY	24
1.8 SCOPE AND LIMITATIONS.....	25
1.9 CHAPTERISATION SCHEME.....	26
CHAPTER 2	33
CONCEPTUALIZING GREENWASHING AND CORPORATE GOVERNANCE INTERVENTION..	33
2.1 THE EVOLUTION AND FOUNDATIONAL DEFINITIONS OF GREENWASHING	33
2.1.1 Genesis of the Term.....	33
2.1.2 Defining Greenwashing: Core Elements and Conceptual Nuances	34
2.1.3 Evolution and Contemporary Frameworks.....	35
2.2 THEORETICAL FRAMEWORKS FOR UNDERSTANDING GREENWASHING.....	41
2.2.1 Legitimacy Theory and Symbolic Management.....	41
2.2.2 Stakeholder Theory and External Pressures.....	42
2.2.3 Decoupling Theory and the Mechanism of Greenwashing	43
2.2.4 Institutional Theory and the Pressure to look responsible.....	44
2.3 TYPOLOGY OF GREENWASHING	45
2.3.1 Product-Level Greenwashing.....	45
2.3.2 Corporate-Level Greenwashing (Organisational Image Management).....	46
2.3.3 ESG Greenwashing (Sustainability Reporting and Financial Sector).....	49
2.4 CONSEQUENCES OF GREENWASHING	51
2.4.1 Environmental and Societal Harm.....	52
2.4.2 Economic and Market Distortions.....	52
2.4.3 Erosion of Trust and Legitimacy.....	53
2.5 EVIDENCE OF IMPACT OF GREENWASHING FROM SECONDARY DATA.....	53
2.5.1 India.....	54
2.5.2 Abroad.....	58
2.6 THE CASE FOR CORPORATE GOVERNANCE INTERVENTION	61
2.6.1 The Consumer Protection Act, 2019.....	61
2.6.2 CCPA Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Greenwashing, 2024.....	62
2.6.3 Structural Limitations: A Doctrinal Analysis.....	64
2.6.4 Greenwashing as Corporate Governance Failure.....	66

2.6.5 <i>The Doctrinal Framework for Upcoming Analysis</i>	68
2.7 CONCLUSION	68
CHAPTER 3	71
GREENWASHING: CORPORATE RESPONSIBILITY AND ACCOUNTABILITY	71
3.1 JURISPRUDENTIAL AND THEORETICAL FRAMEWORKS OF CORPORATE RESPONSIBILITY	71
3.1.1 <i>Fiction Theory</i>	71
3.1.2 <i>Realist Theory</i>	72
3.1.3 <i>Purpose Theory</i>	73
3.1.4 <i>Stakeholder Theory</i>	73
3.1.5 <i>Contractual Theory</i>	74
3.1.6 <i>Synthesis</i>	75
3.2 GENESIS AND EVOLUTION OF CORPORATE RESPONSIBILITY IN SOCIETY	75
3.2.1 <i>Ancient Origins and Medieval Foundations</i>	75
3.2.2 <i>Early Modern Chartered Companies</i>	76
3.2.3 <i>The Industrial Era</i>	77
3.2.4 <i>Conceptualization, Formalization and Regulatory Constraint (1930s–1970s)</i>	78
3.3 JURISPRUDENTIAL ANALYSIS OF CORPORATE RESPONSIBILITY THROUGH HOHFELDIAN PRINCIPLES	81
3.3.1 <i>Ambiguity of Corporate Purpose and utility of Hohfeldian Analysis</i>	81
3.3.2 <i>Decomposing Corporate Responsibility and Liability</i>	83
3.3.3 <i>Designing Responsible Corporate Governance</i>	85
3.3.4 <i>Direct relevance to Greenwashing</i>	87
3.4 PRINCIPAL-AGENT THEORY AND INFORMATION ASYMMETRY	89
3.5 FROM VOLUNTARY CSR TO MANDATORY ESG: THE INDIAN TRANSITION	91
3.5.1 <i>Section 135 and the Mandatory CSR Regime</i>	91
3.5.2 <i>SEBI's BRSR Framework: Evolution and Requirements</i>	93
3.5.3 <i>Assurance Gaps: Limited vs. Reasonable Assurance</i>	95
3.5.4 <i>Critical Assessment: Has the Transition Enhanced Accountability?</i>	97
3.5.5 <i>The Accountability Vacuum: Responsibility versus Accountability</i>	98
3.6 FIDUCIARY DUTIES AND ENVIRONMENTAL ACCOUNTABILITY UNDER INDIAN LAW	100
3.6.1 <i>The Environmental Protection Mandate in Companies Act, 2013</i>	102
3.6.2 <i>Interpreting “Protection of Environment” as a Director’s Duty</i>	103
3.6.3 <i>Greenwashing as a Breach of Fiduciary Duty</i>	104
3.6.4 <i>The Absence of Specific Penal Provisions for Environmental Misrepresentation</i>	105
3.6.5 <i>The M.K. Ranjitsinh Judgment: Constitutional Foundation for Director Environmental Accountability</i>	107
3.6.6 <i>Summary of Doctrinal Findings on Section 166(2) (Lex Lata)</i>	108

3.7 CONCLUSION	109
CHAPTER 4	112
PREVENTION OF GREENWASHING: INTERNATIONAL PERSPECTIVE.....	112
4.1 INTERNATIONAL STANDARDS AND GLOBAL NORMATIVE FRAMEWORKS.....	113
4.1.1 ISO 14021 and Technical Substantiation.....	114
4.1.2 UN High-Level Expert Group and the “Integrity Matters” Report.....	115
4.1.3 IOSCO Report on Supervisory Practices Related to Greenwashing.....	117
4.1.4 Comparative Analytical Framework.....	117
4.2 THE EUROPEAN UNION: CONVERGENT HARD-LAW FRAMEWORK	119
4.2.1 The Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (CSRD)	119
4.2.2 The Green Claims Directive (Proposed)	121
4.2.3 The Empowering Consumers for the Green Transition Directive (ECGT Directive).....	123
4.2.4 EU Enforcement Practice	124
4.3 THE UNITED STATES: FRAGMENTED FRAMEWORK UNDER POLITICAL PRESSURE.....	126
4.3.1 SEC Climate Disclosure Rules: Adopted and Stayed	127
4.3.2 FTC Green Guides: Enforcement Without Binding Force	128
4.3.3 Private Litigation: Emerging Greenwashing Claims.....	130
4.4 THE UNITED KINGDOM: PRESCRIPTIVE RULE WITH UNCERTAIN ENFORCEMENT TRAJECTORY	130
4.4.1 The FCA Anti-Greenwashing Rule (May 2024)	131
4.4.2 Competition and Markets Authority (CMA) Powers.....	132
4.4.3 The UK Green Claims Code.....	133
4.5 CANADA: LEGISLATIVE INNOVATION WITH IMPLEMENTATION AMBIGUITY	134
4.5.1 Bill C-59 Amendments to the Competition Act (June 2024)	134
4.5.2 Competition Bureau Guidelines (June 2025)	135
4.6 AUSTRALIA: ASIC-LED SURVEILLANCE WITH MANDATORY REGIME IN PREPARATION	136
4.6.1 ASIC’s Greenwashing Interventions (2023-2024)	136
4.6.2 Mandatory Climate Reporting Regime (In Preparation).....	137
4.7 DEVELOPING COUNTRY FRAMEWORKS: HETEROGENEOUS MATURITY	138
4.7.1 Latin America: Emerging Stringency.....	138
4.7.2 Southeast Asia: Taxonomies and Regional Convergence.....	141
4.7.3 Africa: South Africa’s Integrated Governance.....	142
4.7.4 India: Preview	142
4.8 LANDMARK ENFORCEMENT ACTIONS AND JUDICIAL REASONING.....	144
4.8.1 Volkswagen Emissions Scandal: Foundational Precedent.....	145
4.8.2 Daimler Mercedes Emissions Settlement (2022)	145
4.8.3 Shell Netherlands: Corporate Climate Responsibility (2021)	145

4.8.4 Fossilvrij v. KLM: The “Overly Rosy Picture” (2024)	147
4.8.5 JBS USA: The Net-Zero Plan Challenge (2024)	148
4.8.6 ASIC v. Vanguard: The “Green Fund” Exclusion.....	148
4.8.7 ASIC v. Mercer Superannuation (2024)	148
4.8.8 P&G Charmin Greenwashing Claim (2025).....	149
4.9 WHAT THE INTERNATIONAL COMPARISON REVEALS.....	150
<i>Consolidated Comparative Table</i>	150
4.9.1 Research Gap 1: Board-Level Accountability for Environmental Claims.....	152
4.9.2 Research Gap 2: Regulatory Fragmentation as Structural Cause.....	153
4.9.3 Research Gap 3: The Verification Gap (Assurance Models)	153
4.9.4 Research Gap 4: Evolving Morphology (Futurewashing, Offsets)	154
4.9.5 Research Gap 5: Enforcement Record Analysis	154
4.10 CROSS-JURISDICTIONAL LESSONS AND EMERGING BEST PRACTICES	156
4.10.1 Assurance as Credibility Tool.....	156
4.10.2 Director Accountability as Governance Tool.....	157
4.10.3 Substantiation Standards: From Aspiration to Enforcement.....	160
4.10.4 Private Enforcement as Complement to Agency Action.....	160
4.10.5 The “Greenhushing” Risk.....	161
4.10.6 Best Practices for State Regulation.....	161
4.10.7 Best Practices for Corporate Compliance.....	162
4.11 CONCLUSION	163
CHAPTER 5	166
INDIAN REGULATORY ECOSYSTEM TO PREVENT GREENWASHING	166
5.1 CONSTITUTIONAL BEDROCK	166
5.2 THE REGULATORY ECOSYSTEM FOR GREENWASHING.....	171
5.2.1 Pillar 1: Consumer Protection Regime (Product & Advertising Accountability)	172
5.2.2 Pillar 2: Securities & Finance Regime (Capital Market Accountability)	180
5.2.3 Pillar 3: Corporate Governance Regime (Board & MCA Accountability)	185
5.3 BROADER ENVIRONMENTAL REGULATION AND SECTORAL STANDARDS	198
5.3.1 Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 and Delegated Rules	198
5.3.2 The National Green Tribunal: Remedial Powers and Jurisdictional Limitations.....	199
5.3.3 Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI): Sectoral Regulation of Environmental Claims in the Food Industry.....	202
5.3.4 BIS Ecomark Certification Scheme	205
5.3.5 Intellectual Property and Labeling.....	206
5.4 CRITICAL ANALYSIS OF REGULATORY ARCHITECTURE AND SYSTEMIC GAPS	207

5.4.1 Definitional and Terminological Inconsistency.....	207
5.4.2 Structural Fragmentation and Jurisdictional Ambiguity.....	211
5.4.3 The Penalty Arbitrage: Economic Incentives for Greenwashing	218
5.4.4 Regulatory Backsliding and Capture.....	222
5.4.5 Enforcement and Surveillance Limitations.....	225
5.5 CONCLUSION	228
CHAPTER 6.....	230
CONCLUSION.....	230
6.1 KEY FINDINGS OF THE STUDY	230
6.2 TESTING THE HYPOTHESIS.....	237
6.3 SUGGESTIONS & RECOMMENDATIONS	240
BIBLIOGRAPHY	252
A. BOOKS	252
B. REPORTS.....	253
C. STATUTES AND REGULATIONS.....	255
<i>Indian Legislation.....</i>	<i>255</i>
<i>Indian Regulations and Guidelines</i>	<i>255</i>
<i>European Union Legislation</i>	<i>257</i>
<i>United Kingdom Legislation.....</i>	<i>257</i>
<i>United States Legislation and Rules</i>	<i>257</i>
<i>Australian Legislation</i>	<i>258</i>
<i>Brazilian Legislation.....</i>	<i>258</i>
D. RESEARCH PAPERS AND JOURNAL ARTICLES	258
E. CASE LAWS	267
<i>Indian Cases</i>	<i>267</i>
<i>International Cases.....</i>	<i>267</i>
F. OTHER WEBSITES AND ONLINE SOURCES.....	268
APPENDIX-I	276
CERTIFICATES OF SEMINARS AND PUBLISHED PAPERS.....	276
APPENDIX-II	281
PUBLISHED PAPERS	281

DECLARATION

I, Saumya Singh, hereby declare that the work titled “CORPORATE RESPONSIBILITY REGARDING THE CONCERN OF GREENWASHING, POLICY AND LEGAL INITIATIVES: A CRITICAL STUDY,” submitted to Chanakya National Law University, Patna, for the Ph.D. degree in Law, is original research work undertaken by me under the supervision and guidance of Dr. Puripanda Parvateeswararao, Associate Professor of Law, Chanakya National Law University, Patna.

The content of this thesis, in full or in part, has not been submitted to any other institute or university for the award of any degree or any other certificate.

Place:

Date:

Name: Saumya Singh

Roll No. PL-2121

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The completion of this thesis fills me with deep gratitude and humility. I bow in reverence to the Almighty, whose blessings gave me strength, clarity and perseverance throughout this journey.

I express my sincere gratitude to my respected Supervisor, Dr. Puripanda Parvateeswararao, Associate Professor of Law, Chanakya National Law University, Patna, for his invaluable guidance, constant encouragement and unwavering support. His scholarly insight and careful supervision have played a vital role in shaping this research.

I want to extend my sincerest thanks to the Hon'ble Vice-Chancellor, Prof. (Dr.) Faizan Mustafa, for providing a stimulating academic environment for the students and sustained institutional support. I also convey my sincere thanks to the Registrar, Prof. (Dr.) S. P. Singh, and to the Dean, Research and Development, Prof. (Dr.) Ajay Kumar, for their support throughout my doctoral work.

I owe my deepest gratitude to my parents, Mr. Rajesh Singh and Mrs. Anju Singh, for their unconditional love, sacrifices, and constant encouragement. I am equally grateful to my father-in-law and mother-in-law, Mr. Devendra Singh Sisodia and Mrs. Meena Sisodia, for their love, blessings and continuous motivation.

My special appreciation goes to my husband, Mr. Atul Pratap Singh, whose support, understanding and unwavering faith in me sustained me through the most demanding phases of this journey. I also express my heartfelt thanks to my brother, Mr. Dev Singh, for his affection and encouragement throughout this journey.

- Saumya Singh



Chanakya National Law University

[NAAC Accredited]

NYAYA NAGAR, MITHAPUR, PATNA-800 001

Tel. No.: +91-612-2352300, 2352309 • Fax No.: +91-612-2352315

Website : www.cnlu.ac.in • E-mail : registrar@cnlu.ac.in, chanakyalawuniv@gmail.com

Letter No:- Ph.D. /LL.D. /D.Phil.) 164/2008/2023-1759

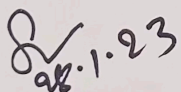
Date: 28.01.2023

CERTIFICATE

Ph.D. COURSE WORK

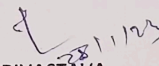
This is to certify that **Saumaya Singh**, Registration/Roll no: **CNLU- PL-2121**, has completed the Six Months Course Work in "Research methodology (4 credits) ;Dissertation writing (4 credits) and Research and Publication Ethics(RPE) for 2-Credits ,total 10 credits, as per para 7 of UGC Regulation, notified in the Gazette of India, No.F.1-2/2009 (EC/PS) V (I) Vol.II. Dated 5th May 2016, (Minimum standards and Procedures for the Award of M.Phil/Ph.D. Degree) and subsequent notification of UGC *vide* its letter No. D.O. No.F.1-1/2018 (Journal/Care) dated December, 2019.

He/She has been declared successful in the Ph.D. Course work examination held in the month of September 2022. He/She is eligible to register further and continue for Ph.D. research work.


28.1.23

Prof. (Dr.) S. C. ROY

Dean Research and Development


28.1.23

M. P. SRIVASTAVA

Dist. Judge (Retd) and Registrar

University established under the Bihar Act No. 24 of 2006 and included under Section 2(f) and eligible under section 12 (B) of the UGC Act and approved by the Bar Council of India.



Chanakya National Law University

[NAAC Accredited]

NYAYA NAGAR, MITHAPUR, PATNA-800 001

Tel. No.: +91-612-2352300, 2352309 • Fax No.: +91-612-2352315

Website : www.cnl.u.ac.in • E-mail : registrar@cnlu.ac.in, chanakyalawuniv@gmail.com

Letter no: CNLU/Ph.D./D.Phil./164/2026- 2\

Date: 04.04.2026

CERTIFICATE of PRE-SUBMISSION SEMINAR ON Ph.D. RESEARCH WORK

This is to certify that **Ms. Saumya Singh**, Ph.D. Research Scholar, Registration No: PL- 2121, presented her research work/thesis titled, “**Corporate Responsibility Regarding the Concern of Greenwashing, Policy and Legal Initiatives: A Critical Study**” under the supervision of Dr. P. P. Rao, in the open seminar on 18.03.2026 at the Conference Hall, CNLU, Patna in the presence of Faculty Members, Research Scholars and Students, from 12.00 noon. The presentation of the Research Scholar was followed by an open discussion on content and research methodology. The participants extended their observations on the quality of work and suggested some improvement to incorporate and submit finally for adjudication.

This is to certify that **Ms. Saumya Singh** has successfully completed the Pre-Submission Seminar as per the requirements.

Prof. (Dr.) Ajay Kumar
Dean Research and Development

Prof. (Dr.) S. P. Singh
Registrar



Chanakya National Law University

[NAAC Accredited]

NYAYA NAGAR, MITHAPUR, PATNA-800 001

Tel. No.: +91-612-2352300, 2352309 • Fax No.: +91-612-2352315

Website : www.cnlu.ac.in • E-mail : registrar@cnlu.ac.in, chanakyalawuniv@gmail.com

Letter No-CNLU/Ph.D./164/2008/2026- 2718

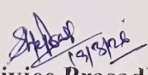
Date: 19.03.2026

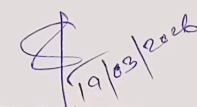
CERTIFICATE OF PLAGIARISM TEST

This is to certify that the thesis titled "**CORPORATE RESPONSIBILITY REGARDING THE CONCERN OF GREENWASHING, POLICY AND LEGAL INITIATIVES: A CRITICAL STUDY**", submitted by **Ms. Saumya Singh**, Research Scholar (**PL-2121**), under the supervision of **Dr. P. P. Rao**, for the award of the Ph.D. degree in Law, has undergone plagiarism screening.

The research document was submitted via email **saumyasingh.bharadwaj@gmail.com** to the University Library for Plagiarism Testing. The document was received on 19/03/2026 at 02:33 PM, and the plagiarism report was generated on 19/03/2026 at 03:05 PM using **Turnitin Software**

The similarity report is **03% (Three Percent)**, which is well within the permissible limit as prescribed under the UGC (Promotion of Academic Integrity and Prevention of Plagiarism in Higher Educational Institutions) Regulations, 2018, notified vide Regulation No. F.1.18/2010(CPP-II), dated 23rd July 2018.


(**Dr. Shivjee Prasad**)
Sr. Library Assistant
CNLU, Patna


(**Dr. Md. Saifiullah**)
Assistant Professor of Management
In charge – Plagiarism & Project
Nodal Officer UGC

University established under the Bihar Act No. 24 of 2006 and included under Section 2(f) and eligible under section 12 (B) of the UGC Act and approved by the Bar Council of India.



Chanakya National Law University

[NAAC Accredited]

NYAYA NAGAR, MITHAPUR, PATNA-800 001

Tel. No.: +91-612-2352300, 2352309 | Fax No.: +91-612-2352315

Website: www.cnlu.ac.in E-mail : registrar@cnlu.ac.in, chanakyalawuniv@gmail.com

SUPERVISOR CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the thesis titled "CORPORATE RESPONSIBILITY REGARDING THE CONCERN OF GREENWASHING, POLICY AND LEGAL INITIATIVES: A CRITICAL STUDY," submitted by Ms. Saumya Singh (CNLU-PL-2121), Research Scholar at Chanakya National Law University, Patna, for the award of the degree of Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) in Law, is a record of bona fide research work carried out by her under my supervision and guidance. The research work is original and the thesis is fit to be submitted for evaluation for the award of the Ph.D. degree in Law.

Date: 28/4/2026

Place: PATNA

Dr. Puripanda Parvateeswararao

Associate Professor of Law

Chanakya National Law University, Patna

Supervisor

University established under the Bihar Act No. 24 of 2006 and included under Section 2(f) and eligible under section 12 (B) of the UGC Act and approved by the Bar Council of India.

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

Abbreviation	Full Form
AA1000AS	Accountability AA1000 Assurance Standard
ACCC	Australian Competition and Consumer Commission
AEX	Amsterdam Exchange Index
AGR	Anti-Greenwashing Rule
AMC	Advertisement and Claims Monitoring Committee
APEC	Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation
ASEAN	Association of Southeast Asian Nations
ASAM	Advertising Standards Malaysia
ARB	Advertising Regulatory Board
ASCI	Advertising Standards Council of India
ASIC	Australian Securities and Investments Commission
AUD	Australian Dollar
AUM	Assets Under Management
B2C	Business-to-Consumer
BEE	Bureau of Energy Efficiency
BIS	Bureau of Indian Standards
BRR	Business Responsibility Report
BRSR	Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting

CCPA	Central Consumer Protection Authority
CCS	Competition and Consumer Commission of Singapore
CEO	Chief Executive Officer
CER	Corporate Environmental Responsibility
CFC	Chlorofluorocarbon
CO ₂	Carbon Dioxide
CMA	Competition and Markets Authority
COBS	Conduct of Business Sourcebook
CONAR	Conselho Nacional de Autorregulamentacao Publicitaria (Advertising Self-Regulatory Council)
COP27	27th Conference of the Parties
CPA	Consumer Protection Act
CPC	Consumer Protection Cooperation Network
CPCB	Central Pollution Control Board
CPFTA	Consumer Protection (Fair Trading) Act
CR	Corporate Responsibility
CRISIL	Credit Rating Information Services of India Limited
CSR	Corporate Social Responsibility
CSRD	Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive
CVM	Comissao de Valores Mobiliarios (Brazilian Securities Commission)

DGCCRF	Direction generale de la concurrence, de la consommation et de la repression des fraudes
DMCCA	Digital Markets, Competition and Consumers Act
ECGT	Empowering Consumers for the Green Transition Directive
ECHR	European Convention on Human Rights
EPA	Environment (Protection) Act, 1986
EPR	Extended Producer Responsibility
ERP	ESG Rating Provider
ESG	Environmental, Social and Governance
ESMA	European Securities and Markets Authority
ESRS	European Sustainability Reporting Standards
EU	European Union
FCA	Financial Conduct Authority
FMCG	Fast-Moving Consumer Goods
FoSCoS	Food Safety Compliance System
FICCI	Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry
FSC	Forest Stewardship Council
FSS Act	Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006
FSSAI	Food Safety and Standards Authority of India
FTC	Federal Trade Commission
FY	Financial Year

GCD	Green Claims Directive
GHG	Greenhouse Gas
GSS+	Green, Social, Sustainability, and Sustainability-Linked
HLEG	High-Level Expert Group
HUL	Hindustan Unilever Limited
IAASB	International Auditing and Assurance Standards Board
ICSI	Institute of Company Secretaries of India
IFRS	International Financial Reporting Standards
IOSCO	International Organization of Securities Commissions
IP	Intellectual Property
ISAE	International Standard on Assurance Engagements
ISF	Industry Standards Forum
ISO	International Organization for Standardization
ISSA	International Standard on Sustainability Assurance
ISSB	International Sustainability Standards Board
KBA	Kraftfahrt-Bundesamt (German Federal Motor Transport Authority)
LCA	Life Cycle Assessment
LEED	Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design
LODR	Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements
MAS	Monetary Authority of Singapore

MCA	Ministry of Corporate Affairs
MIB	Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
MoEF	Ministry of Environment and Forests
MoEFCC	Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
MSCI	Morgan Stanley Capital International
MSME	Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
MUFG	Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group
NABL	National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories
NCLAT	National Company Law Appellate Tribunal
NCLT	National Company Law Tribunal
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NGRBC	National Guidelines on Responsible Business Conduct
NGT	National Green Tribunal
NIFTY 50	National Stock Exchange Fifty Index
NPOP	National Programme for Organic Production
NSE	National Stock Exchange
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
PCR	Product Category Rules
PFUTP	Prohibition of Fraudulent and Unfair Trade Practices
PGS-India	Participatory Guarantee System for India

PPP	Polluter Pays Principle
QR	Quick Response
RBI	Reserve Bank of India
ROC	Registrar of Companies
SAF	Sustainable Aviation Fuel
SASB	Sustainability Accounting Standards Board
SAT	Securities Appellate Tribunal
SBTi	Science Based Targets initiative
SCC	Supreme Court Cases
SDC	Self-Declaration Certificate
SEBI	Securities and Exchange Board of India
SEC	Securities and Exchange Commission
SFIO	Serious Fraud Investigation Office
SGX	Singapore Exchange
SPCB	State Pollution Control Board
SSBJ	Sustainability Standards Board of Japan
TCFD	Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures
UCPD	Unfair Commercial Practices Directive
UK	United Kingdom
UN	United Nations

UOI	Union of India
URL	Uniform Resource Locator
US	United States
USD	United States Dollar
WP(C)	Writ Petition (Civil)

LIST OF CASES

- Rural Litigation and Entitlement Kendra, Dehradun and Ors. v. State of Uttar Pradesh and Ors. (1985)
- M.C. Mehta v. Union of India (Oleum Gas Leak Case) (1987)
- Charan Lal Sahu v. Union of India (1990)
- Indian Council for Enviro-Legal Action v. Union of India (1996)
- Vellore Citizens' Welfare Forum v. Union of India and Ors. (1996)
- M.C. Mehta v. Kamal Nath (1997)
- Volkswagen Emissions Scandal (2015)
- Volkswagen India Pvt. Ltd. (2019)
- In re LG Polymers India Pvt Ltd (2020)
- Milieudefensie et al. v Royal Dutch Shell plc (2021)
- Tata Consultancy Services Ltd v. Cyrus Investments Pvt Ltd & Ors. (2021)
- Daimler Mercedes Emissions Settlement (2022)
- ASIC v. Mercer Superannuation (2024)
- ASIC v. Vanguard (2024)
- Fossielvrij NL v. KLM Royal Dutch Airlines (2024)
- Indian Medical Association & Anr. v. Union of India & Ors. (2024)
- M.K. Ranjitsinh & Ors. v. Union of India & Ors. (2024, 2025)
- People of the State of New York v. JBS USA Food Co. (2024)
- P&G Charmin Greenwashing Claim (2025)

LIST OF STATUTES

- Competition Act, 1985 (Canada)
- BIS Act, 1986 (India)
- Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 (India)
- Securities and Exchange Board of India Act, 1992 (India)
- Trade Marks Act, 1999 (India)
- Companies Act 2006 (United Kingdom)
- Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006 (India)
- National Green Tribunal Act, 2010 (India)
- Companies Act, 2013 (India)
- Consumer Protection Act, 2019 (India)
- Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (2022) (European Union)
- Digital Markets, Competition and Consumers Act 2024 (United Kingdom)
- Empowering Consumers for the Green Transition Directive (2024) (European Union)